

Chapter 31 Part 5

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Xu Qingzhu's foot wasn't seriously injured - just a minor sprain without bone damage. The doctor applied some medicine and did a simple bandage, and that was it.

When Liang Shi brought Xu Qingzhu to the company, it was exactly eight-fifty.

She even left Xu Qingzhu ten minutes to get upstairs.

By the time she reached her own company, it was already nine-thirty.

Half an hour late.

When she clocked in, that mechanical electronic voice sounded again, once more subjecting her to public execution in front of everyone.

Everyone in the office area looked over, but then turned away, not thinking it was a big deal.

What could it be anyway?

Although she was new, on her first day she had taken down the arrogant Editor-in-Chief Sun. Everyone knew she wasn't simple.

Being late - what was that? Was it even an issue?

Not at all.

Even if she didn't come for a whole day and still got paid, it had nothing to do with these working people.

Besides, as long as the magazine department director position remained vacant, it meant this newcomer could be promoted to magazine department director at any time.

No one would point fingers at someone with connections.

So everyone was quite calm. After all, when Liang Shi hadn't come to the company yesterday, everyone had already privately discussed this new employee.

Opinions about her identity varied, but according to a well-informed colleague's conclusion, she was the uneducated and arrogant third young lady of the Liang family.

Colleagues from the HR department were quite shocked to hear that she hadn't ransacked their department but had only fired Editor-in-Chief Sun.

Because that person had previously caused a bloodbath in the HR department - more outrageous than a destructive husky¹. The HR director's office was left in complete disarray, and they almost quit.

Why did they stay in the end?

Probably due to life's pressures.

In any case, everyone knew not to provoke this person.

Liang Shi had nothing to do all morning. Everyone was busy with their own work. The little girl next to her workstation was still there, still quietly reading.

And she was reading "Pride and Prejudice."

She wondered if such a young child could understand it.

She was so quiet that her presence could easily be ignored.

She must be some colleague's child.

With nothing else to do, Liang Shi found a movie to watch, wearing headphones. She was watching a science fiction film. In this world, the development of sci-fi films was faster than in her original world. Perhaps with gender differentiation, human intelligence had generally improved, leading to better understanding of science fiction.

The one she was watching was called "Borders," with quite a grand production.

Halfway through, she noticed something beside her. Turning her head, she saw the little girl leaning over to watch, staring intently.

This movie was entirely in English. Although there were subtitles, many words weren't common, and some were even obscure - not very friendly for such a young child.

Liang Shi wouldn't deprive a child of the joy of watching movies, but still asked, "Can you understand it?"

The little girl's voice was crisp: "Is it about aliens invading Earth? That person just now is a spy, right?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was truly surprised.

Because in the known plot, that person had always existed as an Earthling, with only subtle hints planted, never explicitly stating that he was a spy.

Liang Shi had extensive film knowledge, so she guessed that person was a spy, but she hadn't expected such a young girl to see through it at first glance.

She couldn't help but be curious: "Little friend, how old are you?"

The little girl's eyes were still fixed on her computer. Liang Shi took off her headphones and paused the movie, looking at her seriously.

With the movie paused, the little girl seemed a bit disappointed, but she politely answered, "I'm six years old."

"You're the same age as my niece!" Liang Shi said. "My niece is also six this year. But don't you go to school?"

She said frankly, "I got in a fight with a classmate and was ordered to reflect for a month."

"And you're proud of it?" Editorial team leader Zhou Li turned around to look at her, and she lowered her head.

Liang Shi immediately understood - this was their team leader's daughter.

"I was clearly helping someone in need!" the little girl said quietly.

Zhou Li glanced at her: "Don't disturb your mother's colleague's work."

"It's fine," Liang Shi said. "You go ahead with your work. I have nothing to do anyway."

After saying this, she added, "If you have anything you need me to do, just let me know."

Zhou Li looked at her meaningfully: "Not at the moment, but you need to familiarize yourself with the company employee handbook. There's a meeting at three this afternoon. After the meeting, I'll discuss your future work content with you."

"Okay."

After that, Zhou Li immersed herself in work and stopped paying attention to the little girl.

Liang Shi asked the little girl, "What's your name?"

"Rainbow," the little girl said. "Zhou Caihong."

"Your English pronunciation is so standard!" Liang Shi said. "Have you lived abroad?"

"My father is a foreigner, currently abroad," Rainbow said. "I've always been with my mother - bilingual education."

She spoke nothing like a six-year-old child - clear and logical, with precise word choice.

Liang Shi asked her again, "Can you understand English?"

Rainbow said, "Simple things, yes."

So Liang Shi handed her an earbud: "Want to watch together?"

Rainbow pulled over a chair and sat beside her.

Footnotes:

¹ "Destructive husky" - A common internet reference in Chinese culture, referring to Siberian Huskies' reputation for being hyperactive and destructive when bored, often used to describe chaotic or destructive behavior.